





Celebrities



Discuss:

What is a celebrity?

What kinds of people are celebrities?

Who are famous celebrities in your country?

Think



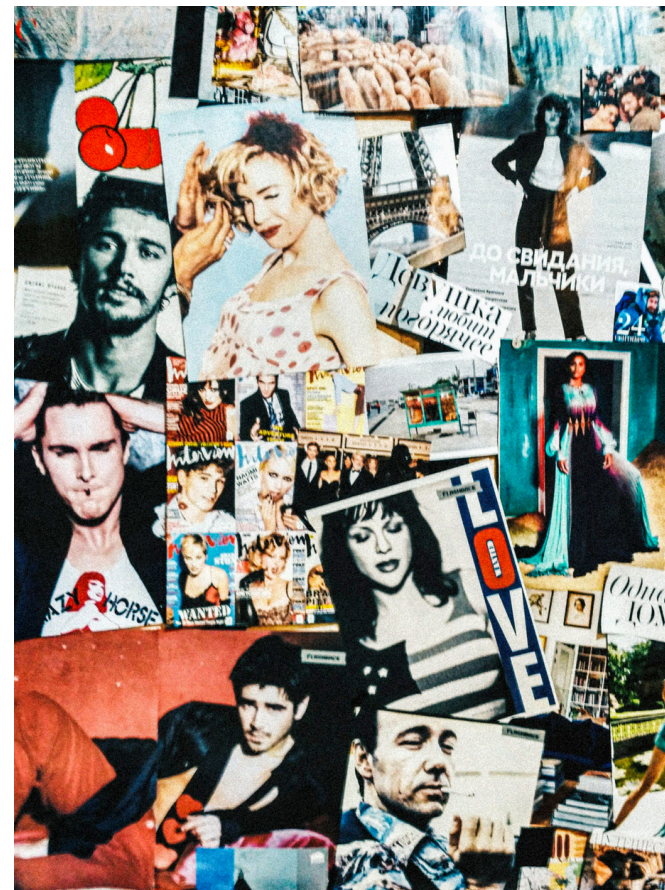
Some people say that the concept of “celebrity” is disappearing, and that younger generations are **not** usually interested in celebrities.

Do you think this is true? Why?

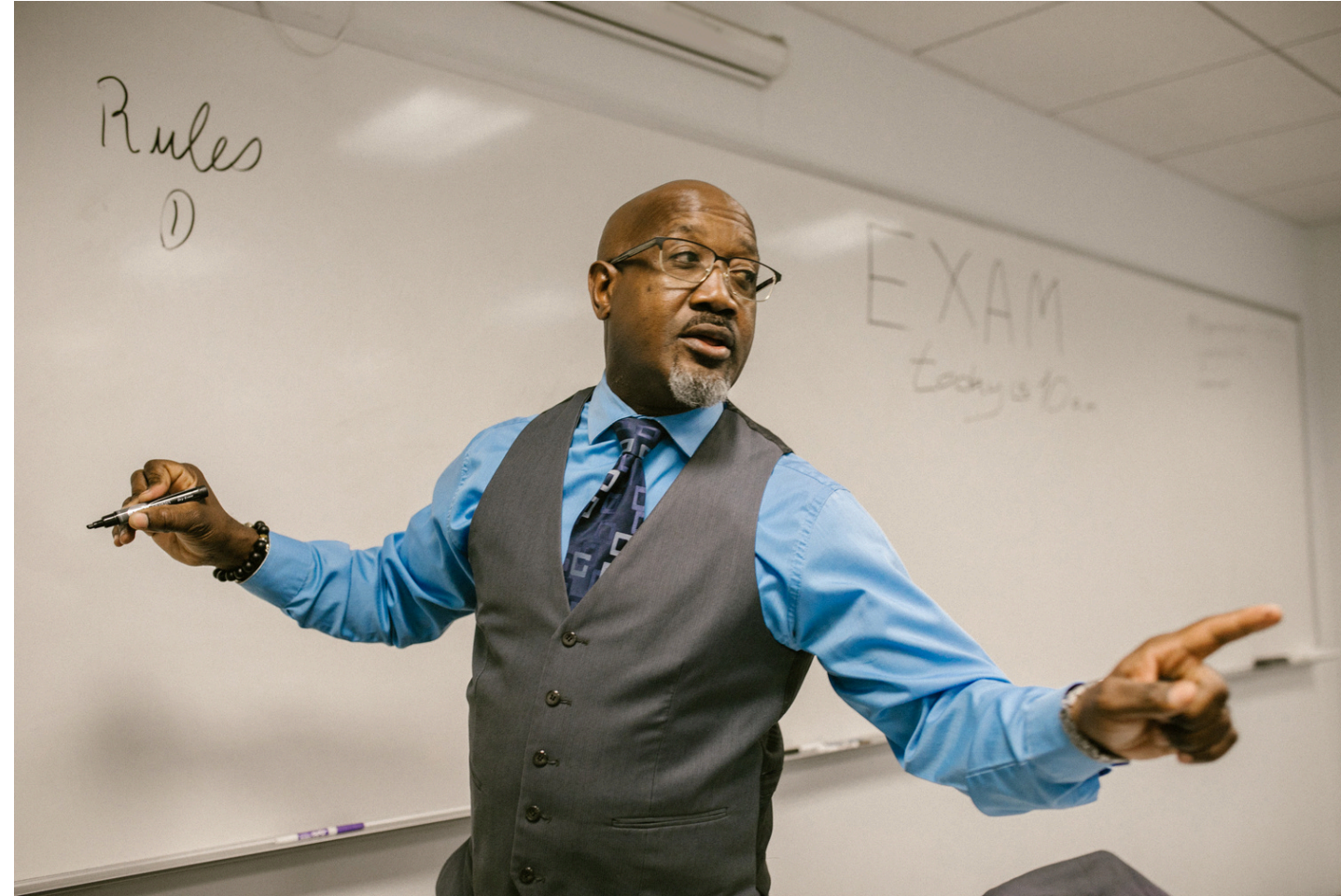


Think

Do you think it is positive for young people
to have famous role models?
Why / Why not?



Think



Can a teacher be a celebrity?!



It's time to read the news!



We are going to read an article called **Professor Biao Xiang:
The Unlikely Celebrity Helping Anxious Young People.**

What do you expect to read about?

While you read, make a note of any words you don't
understand.



A quick note on some of the vocabulary from the news article before we start reading

Unexpected = surprising

Anthropologist = someone who studies human behaviour

Developed = advanced

Career = a person's professional jobs

Degree = a course at university

Exhausted = very tired

Worries = concerns, preoccupations

Fears = things that you are scared of



Professor Biao Xiang: The Unlikely Celebrity Helping Anxious Young People



A 54-year-old university professor has become an **unexpected** celebrity among young people in China. Professor Biao Xiang is not a pop star or an actor. He is an **anthropologist** who studies society and social change. However, thousands of young people are now following his talks and treating him almost like an idol.

The reason for his popularity is simple: he talks openly about anxiety and the pressure young people have. China has **developed** very quickly, but this has also created a lot of competition. Young people worry about finding a good job, having a good **career**, relationships and being able to afford a home.

The transition from school to working life can be especially difficult. Many people feel that they must get a good **degree**, find a secure job, get married and buy a house. Because so many people are competing for the same things, they can feel **exhausted** and worried about not being successful.

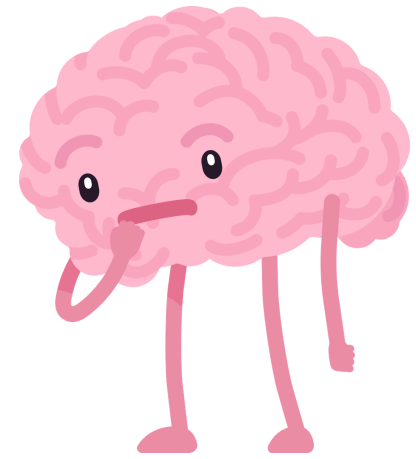
Professor Xiang believes that people often depend too much on exams, jobs and other systems to decide how successful they are. Instead, he encourages young people to understand themselves and find meaning in their relationships with others.

For many of his young fans, Xiang is important because he makes them feel understood. His unusual popularity shows how much young people want someone to talk honestly about their **worries** and **fears**.

Article adapted from [bbc.com](https://www.bbc.com)

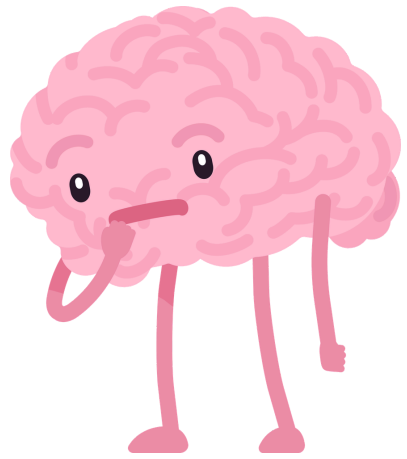
27th September 2026





Check your understanding of the article

1. Who is Professor Biao Xiang?
2. Why do young people like his talks?
3. What topics does he discuss?
4. How is he different from other celebrities?



Check your understanding of the article

1. Who is Professor Biao Xiang?

He is an anthropologist and academic

2. Why do young people like his talks?

He talks honestly about life pressures

3. What topics does he discuss?

Anxiety and pressure

4. How is he different from other celebrities?

He is an academic, not an entertainer



The article talks about a topic which is getting more and more common:
anxiety.

Discuss the questions about this topic on
the next 4 slides.

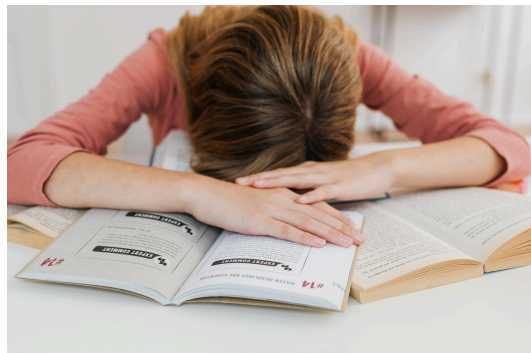


Let's talk about anxiety in young people

Why do you think so many young people feel pressure about their future?



What creates the most pressure for young adults today?



School and exams

Social media



Finding a job

Family expectations







Hot take! What do you think?

**Young people today
have more pressure
than previous
generations**

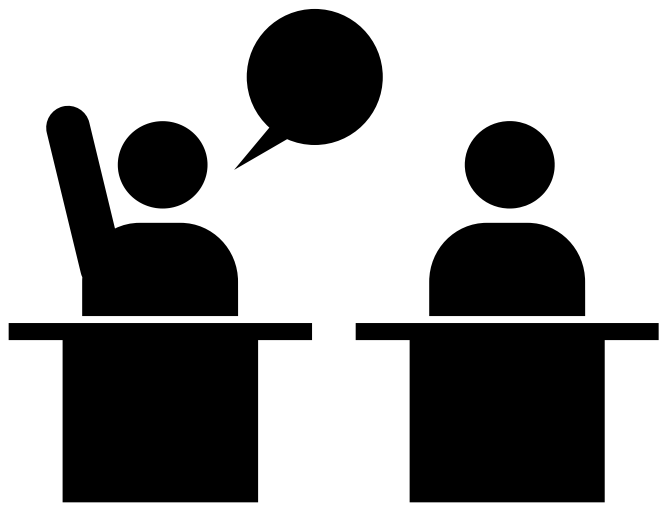




Hot take! What do you think?

**Being successful is
no longer about
making a lot of
money**





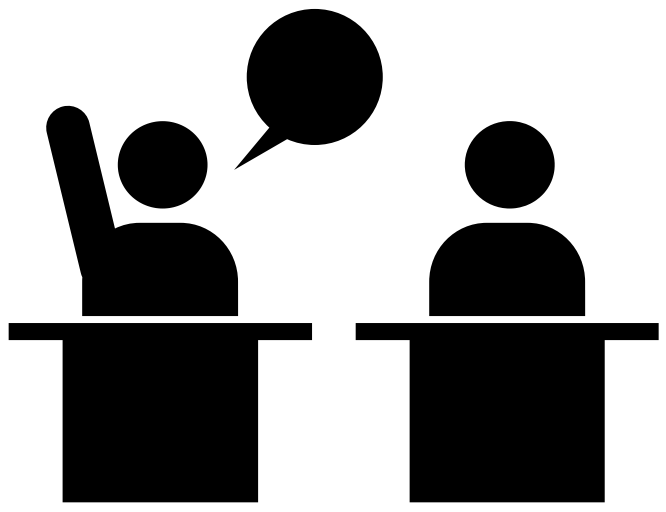
Final Task

To finish this lesson, we are going to have some debates.
Choose a side of the argument and defend it. There are
some useful opinion phrases to help you.

Tip: Whilst debating, use
the ideas which we have
seen and discussed in
this class

Useful phrases

- In my opinion...
- The way I see it...
- As far as I'm concerned...
- From my point of view...



Final Task

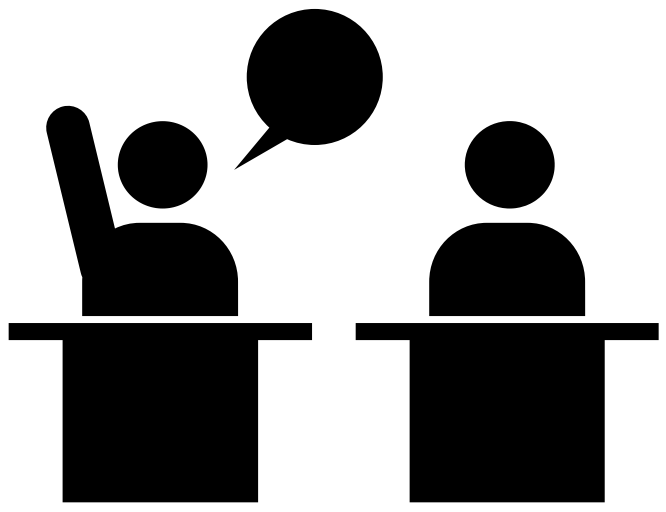
Choose your side, and defend it in the debate

Topic 1 of 2

Young people should
worry less about
having a good career

Useful phrases

- In my opinion...
- The way I see it...
- As far as I'm concerned...
- From my point of view...



Final Task

Choose your side, and defend it in the debate

Topic 2 of 2

Social media should only be
for people who are over 18
years old

Useful phrases

- In my opinion...
- The way I see it...
- As far as I'm concerned...
- From my point of view...



End of lesson review

In this lesson I have

- ✓ Discussed about celebrities
- ✓ Read and understood an article about a celebrity teacher
- ✓ Looked into pressure and anxiety for young people
- ✓ Used a variety of expressions for giving opinions